

Jainism — MCQ Solutions

Seed 8560500507743229150; each question has four synchronized option-specific explanations.

MCQ 1. The systematic anchor of Jaina philosophy

With reference to the Tattvārthasūtra, consider the following statements.

1. It is ascribed to Umāsvāti in Śvetāmbara usage and to Umāsvāmī in Digambara usage.
2. Its authority is confined to one of the two major traditions, which is why sectarian canons differ.
3. It states the path to liberation through right vision, right knowledge and right conduct together.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1, 2 and 3
- B. 1 and 3 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1 and 2 only

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: statements 1 and 3 are sound, but including 2 contradicts them by denying the very cross-sectarian acceptance that makes the text quotable for both traditions.
- B: Correct: the double ascription and the joint three-jewel path formula are both standard, and together they explain why the text functions as a shared systematic grammar.
- C: Incorrect: it drops the double ascription that names the text's cross-sectarian standing while keeping the false restriction of its authority.
- D: Incorrect: it retains statement 2, which confines the text to a single tradition, whereas the Tattvārthasūtra is precisely the rare work treated as authoritative across both.

Examiner trap: Shared textual authority is not doctrinal uniformity; the same sūtra text can anchor both traditions while canon, monastic practice and several details continue to diverge.

MCQ 2. What the title-words of the tradition actually mean

In Jaina usage, the terms jina and tīrthaṅkara respectively designate

- A. one who has conquered the passions and karmic bondage, and a liberated teacher who re-establishes the crossing over rebirth
- B. the first teacher of the present cycle alone, and any monk who has completed the five great vows under supervision
- C. the creator of the ordered cosmos, and the divine agent who allots merit and demerit to embodied beings at each rebirth
- D. a soul that has suppressed delusion temporarily, and a householder who has taken the lesser vows before ordination

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- A: Correct: jina is the conqueror of passions from whom the tradition takes its name, and a tīrthaṅkara is the ford-maker who rebuilds the crossing over the cycle of rebirth.

- B: Incorrect: it confuses a title of spiritual achievement with a chronological rank and with ordinary monastic completion of the vows.
- C: Incorrect: it smuggles creation and divine allotment into a system that explains inequality by action-matter and denies a creator altogether.
- D: Incorrect: temporary suppression of delusion belongs to the eleventh stage, and lesser vows belong to householders; neither term is defined that way.

Examiner trap: Reverence for perfected teachers is not theism; Jainism honours achieved perfection while denying that any being made or governs the world.

MCQ 3. The definition of the real

In the Jaina formula *utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya-yuktaṃ sat*, the real is characterised by

- A. origination alone, since a thing is nothing more than the series of its successive productions
- B. origination, decay and persistence taken together, in one and the same real
- C. persistence alone, since change belongs only to appearance and never to the substance itself
- D. decay alone, since every determinate thing is defined by the moment at which it ceases

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: a pure series of productions is closer to momentariness and leaves recognition of the same gold across the change unexplained.
- B: Correct: the real is defined by origination, decay and persistence together, which is what allows permanence to be predicated of substance and change of mode.
- C: Incorrect: reducing change to appearance is the static-monist error that Jainism explicitly rejects, since it cannot explain why the bracelet actually became a ring.
- D: Incorrect: making cessation definitional inverts the doctrine, because persistence is precisely the term that blocks a purely momentary reading.

Examiner trap: The three terms are joint, not alternative; a script that offers "permanence with some change" has already lost the definition, because change is constitutive rather than conceded.

MCQ 4. Substance, quality and mode

Which statement correctly states the relation among substance (*dravya*), quality (*guṇa*) and mode (*paryāya*)?

- A. Substance is an inference from modes alone, since qualities are conventional descriptions with no bearer
- B. Quality and mode are two names for the same changing state, distinguished only by the standpoint of the observer
- C. Quality is the abiding characteristic of a persisting substance, while mode is the changing state in which it appears
- D. Mode is the abiding characteristic of a substance, while quality is the momentary state it currently exhibits

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: treating the substance as a mere inference concedes the Buddhist nominalist case that Jainism answers by insisting that changes require something whose changes they are.
- B: Incorrect: collapsing the two removes the distinction that lets Jainism assert permanence and change of one thing in different respects.

- C: Correct: qualities belong to the substance as abiding characteristics, whereas modes are its changing states, which is why consciousness is a quality of the soul while delusion is a mode.
- D: Incorrect: it exactly reverses the two terms, which is the most frequent examinable confusion in this part of the syllabus.

Examiner trap: Consciousness is a guṇa of the soul; pleasure, pain, delusion and liberated omniscience are paryāyas — the same soul, different states.

MCQ 5. Substances and extended substances

Which one of the following is a real substance (dravya) in mainstream Jaina exposition but not an extended substance (astikāya)?

- A. Time (kāla)
- B. Medium of rest (adharma)
- C. Matter (pudgala)
- D. Space (ākāśa)

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- A: Correct: time is admitted as a substance but is not an extended substance, which is why the tradition speaks of five extended substances plus time.
- B: Incorrect: the medium of rest is an extended substance co-extensive with world-space, on a par with the medium of motion.
- C: Incorrect: matter is extended and aggregative, and it is additionally the only substance that possesses form.
- D: Incorrect: space is an extended substance, articulated as world-space and the space beyond the world, and it accommodates the other substances.

Examiner trap: Six substances but five extended substances; writing "six astikāyas" converts a precise doctrine into an avoidable factual error.

MCQ 6. Two substances with misleading names

In Jaina ontology, dharma-dravya and adharma-dravya respectively signify

- A. the medium that makes motion possible and the medium that makes rest possible for souls and matter
- B. accumulated merit and accumulated demerit, which jointly determine the quality of the next embodiment
- C. right conduct and wrong conduct, understood as the two moral orientations available to an embodied soul
- D. the ordering principle of the cosmos and the disordering principle that produces decay within it

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- A: Correct: they are enabling conditions of movement and rest, comparable to water for a swimming fish, and they are co-extensive with world-space.
- B: Incorrect: merit and demerit are punya and pāpa, which appear in the ninefold list of categories, not in the sixfold list of substances.
- C: Incorrect: conduct is treated under right conduct and the vows; the substances in question are cosmological conditions, not moral orientations.
- D: Incorrect: no Jaina text assigns them cosmic order and disorder; they enable motion and rest without themselves pushing or halting anything.

Examiner trap: The same two Sanskrit words carry a moral sense elsewhere in Indian philosophy; in Jaina ontology they are strictly media, and the shift of sense is deliberately examined.

MCQ 7. The Jaina conception of the soul

Which statement best expresses the Jaina conception of the soul (jīva)?

- A. It is one universal consciousness that appears as many only through the beginningless operation of ignorance
- B. It is a stream of momentary cognitions with no bearer, so that personal identity is a useful conventional fiction
- C. It is an eternal substance that becomes conscious only when the internal organ is conjoined with it in embodiment
- D. It is one of innumerable distinct substances, intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: this is the Advaita position; Jainism holds that souls are numerically many and remain distinct even after liberation.
- B: Incorrect: this is the Buddhist no-self account, which Jainism rejects because bondage and liberation require an enduring knower.
- C: Incorrect: this is the Nyāya account of a self that knows through conjunction with the internal organ; in Jainism consciousness is intrinsic.
- D: Correct: souls are innumerable, beginningless and intrinsically endowed with the infinite tetrad, which is obscured rather than absent in bondage.

Examiner trap: Intrinsic omniscience is not empirical omniscience; the soul's infinite knowledge is present as capacity and obscured in fact, which is exactly what action-matter is introduced to explain.

MCQ 8. What is distinctive about matter

Which feature uniquely marks matter (pudgala) among the six substances?

- A. It alone possesses form, that is colour, taste, smell and touch, and is therefore sense-perceptible
- B. It alone undergoes origination and decay, the remaining substances being exempt from modal change
- C. It alone lacks space-points, which is why it can be divided indefinitely without any residue remaining
- D. It alone is co-extensive with world-space and therefore accommodates every other substance within it

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- A: Correct: matter is the sole substance with form, which is why sound is classed as a material modification and why karmic matter can adhere at all.
- B: Incorrect: every substance has modes; origination and decay belong to the definition of the real as such, not to matter alone.
- C: Incorrect: matter is extended and aggregative, built from indivisible atoms combining into aggregates, so indefinite division without residue is not the Jaina view.
- D: Incorrect: accommodation is the function of space; matter occupies room rather than providing it.

Examiner trap: In Jainism sound is a modification of matter, not a quality of ether; importing the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika treatment of sound here is a silent cross-school error.

MCQ 9. Ordinary perception in the strict Jaina classification

In the strict Jaina epistemological classification, ordinary sensory cognition is

- A. a species of scriptural knowledge, since every perceptual judgement is already structured by inherited verbal categories
- B. only conventional direct knowledge, and strictly belongs with mediated cognition because it depends on sense and mind
- C. invalid cognition, because the senses are themselves products of karmic matter and therefore systematically deceive
- D. direct knowledge in the fullest sense, since sense-contact provides the clearest access available to an embodied knower

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: verbal knowledge is derived from sense-and-mind cognition rather than constituting it, so the dependence runs the other way.
- B: Correct: ordinary perception is *sāṃvyaṭvahārika pratyakṣa*, direct for practical purposes but mediated by organ, mind and karmic limitation.
- C: Incorrect: ordinary perception is valid for practical dealings, and its wrongness arises only under wrong orientation, not from the senses as such.
- D: Incorrect: this is the Nyāya expectation; Jainism measures directness by absence of mediation, not by sensory clarity.

Examiner trap: The Jaina and Nyāya senses of *pratyakṣa* differ; using the word without the qualifier "conventional" imports a rival classification into a Jaina answer.

MCQ 10. Classifying the five kinds of knowledge

Which pair is correctly classified as indirect (*parokṣa*) in the basic fivefold scheme of knowledge?

- A. Sense-and-mind cognition and clairvoyant knowledge
- B. Sense-and-mind cognition and verbal or scriptural knowledge
- C. Knowledge of others' mental modes and omniscience
- D. Clairvoyant knowledge and knowledge of others' mental modes

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: it pairs one genuinely mediated kind with one strictly direct kind, so the classification is half right and therefore wrong.
- B: Correct: sense-and-mind cognition and verbal or scriptural knowledge are mediated, the second being derived from the first through signs and teaching.
- C: Incorrect: both are direct, and omniscience is the complete case of directness rather than an instance of mediation.
- D: Incorrect: both members are strictly direct, since the soul knows without the mediation of sense or mind, even though both remain limited.

Examiner trap: Verbal or scriptural knowledge is not blind faith; it is a mediated cognition dependent on prior cognition and communication, and Jainism grades it accordingly.

MCQ 11. The order of the five kinds of knowledge

Which sequence correctly states the five kinds of Jaina knowledge in ascending order?

- A. Avadhi, *manaḥparyāya*, *mati*, *śruta*, *kevala*

- B. Śruta, mati, avadhi, kevala, manaḥparyāya
- C. Mati, śruta, avadhi, manaḥparyāya, kevala
- D. Mati, avadhi, śruta, manaḥparyāya, kevala

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: it places the two direct but limited kinds before the mediated kinds, reversing the logic of progressive unveiling.
- B: Incorrect: it inverts the first pair and places omniscience before knowledge of others' mental modes, breaking the graded removal of obscuration.
- C: Correct: the canonical ascending order runs sense-and-mind cognition, verbal knowledge, clairvoyance, knowledge of others' mental modes, and omniscience.
- D: Incorrect: it inserts clairvoyance between the two mediated kinds, separating verbal knowledge from the sense-and-mind cognition it derives from.

Examiner trap: The order is not a ranking of usefulness but a curve of karmic unveiling; each step marks how much knowledge-obscuring action-matter has been removed.

MCQ 12. Jaina causation

The Jaina account of causation is best described as

- A. dependent origination without any substrate, since causal regularity is all that causal talk records
- B. both-existence-and-non-existence of the effect, since the effect pre-exists as substance and is new as mode
- C. fresh production of the effect without qualification, since the effect is entirely absent before its production
- D. pre-existence of the effect without qualification, since nothing genuinely new can ever be produced

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: dependence without a substrate is the Buddhist framing, which Jainism rejects because it dissolves the persisting bearer of change.
- B: Correct: the effect is continuous with the cause as enduring substance and novel as fresh mode, which is many-sidedness applied to causal identity.
- C: Incorrect: unqualified fresh production is the Nyāya position, and it leaves unexplained why clay yields a jar rather than anything whatever.
- D: Incorrect: unqualified pre-existence is the Sāṃkhya position, and it makes production add nothing at all.

Examiner trap: Calling Jaina causation satkāryavāda is a common slip; the whole point of the Jaina label is the added respect-index that Sāṃkhya does not use.

MCQ 13. What many-sidedness asserts

The doctrine of many-sidedness (anekāntavāda) primarily asserts that

- A. reality is unknowable in itself, so that every description reports only the classificatory habits of the describer
- B. contradictory properties genuinely belong to one thing at one time and in one and the same respect
- C. all judgements are equally true, since standpoints cannot be ranked and disagreement is therefore merely apparent

D. the real object possesses innumerable aspects, so no single unqualified proposition exhausts it

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: unknowability contradicts Jaina realism, which holds that aspects are objectively in the thing and are genuinely reached under standpoints.
- B: Incorrect: identity of respect is exactly what the syāt operator excludes; without different indices there would be a plain contradiction.
- C: Incorrect: equal truth for all judgements is relativism, whereas Jainism grades judgements by whether they respect their own conditions.
- D: Correct: the thesis is that the real is ananta-dharmātmakaṃ vastu, so finite judgement necessarily captures an aspect rather than the whole.

Examiner trap: Many-sidedness is ontology before it is logic; a script that introduces it as tolerance or open-mindedness has lost the derivation that the doctrine of judgement depends on.

MCQ 14. Three doctrines, three levels

Which formulation correctly distinguishes the three doctrines?

- A. Many-sidedness is logical, standpoint theory is ethical, and conditional predication is the metaphysical basis of the other two
- B. Many-sidedness and conditional predication are identical, while standpoint theory is a later scholastic elaboration of both
- C. Many-sidedness is metaphysical, standpoint theory is epistemic, and conditional predication is the logical-linguistic form of assertion
- D. Standpoint theory is metaphysical, conditional predication is epistemic, and many-sidedness is a rule of monastic debate

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: it misassigns every level and turns standpoint theory into ethics, which no Jaina exposition supports.
- B: Incorrect: identifying the metaphysical thesis with the mode of assertion destroys the derivation from object to knower to sentence.
- C: Correct: the three occupy distinct levels, and the sevenfold predication is the formal schema in which the third operates.
- D: Incorrect: reducing many-sidedness to a debating convention removes the ontological claim on which the whole system rests.

Examiner trap: The examiner is testing levels, not vocabulary; naming all three terms without assigning each its level scores as recall rather than understanding.

MCQ 15. The first of the seven standpoints

Which one of the following is the first member of the classical list of seven standpoints (naya)?

- A. Saṃgraha naya, the generic standpoint attending to shared class-character
- B. Evambhūta naya, the standpoint on which a term applies only during actual function
- C. R̥jusūtra naya, the standpoint restricted to the thing in its present state
- D. Naigama naya, the mixed practical or purposive standpoint

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: the generic standpoint is second, and it narrows what the first standpoint leaves deliberately mixed.
- B: Incorrect: the function-in-act standpoint is seventh and the strictest, so placing it first inverts the entire funnel.
- C: Incorrect: the present-state standpoint is fourth and forms the hinge between substance-directed and mode-directed views.
- D: Correct: the mixed practical or purposive standpoint opens the list, blending general and particular, often through intention.

Examiner trap: The list moves from loosest to strictest; reciting it out of order destroys the analytical point that partiality tightens as language becomes more literal.

MCQ 16. Matching a standpoint with its emphasis

Which pairing of a standpoint with its characteristic emphasis is correct?

- A. Evambhūta naya — the term applies only while the named function is being performed
- B. Vyavahāra naya — the etymological differentiation of synonymous words
- C. Śabda naya — the class-character shared by every member of a kind
- D. Saṃgraha naya — the thing considered strictly as it is at the present moment

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- A: Correct: on the function-in-act standpoint a person counts as a singer only while singing is actually occurring.
- B: Incorrect: etymological differentiation belongs to samabhirūḍha, while the practical standpoint concerns ordinary dealings with particulars.
- C: Incorrect: class-character belongs to the generic standpoint, while the verbal standpoint attends to the expression actually used.
- D: Incorrect: the present-moment restriction belongs to rjusūtra; the generic standpoint deliberately abstracts from present particularity.

Examiner trap: The last three standpoints are all verbal, so they are easily swapped; distinguish attention to the word, to its derivation, and to the performance it names.

MCQ 17. What the particle syāt contributes

In the doctrine of conditional predication, the particle syāt is best rendered as

- A. "probably", marking that the assertion is likely but not certain on the evidence available to the speaker
- B. "apparently", marking that the assertion holds for appearances although the thing in itself is unknown
- C. "let it be granted", marking a provisional concession made only for the purposes of a formal debate
- D. "in a certain respect", marking a definite assertion restricted by substance, place, time and mode

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: probability is precisely the reading Jaina authors reject, since the assertion is definite and only its respect is restricted.
- B: Incorrect: an appearance-reality split is alien to Jaina realism, in which aspects are objectively in the thing.
- C: Incorrect: a debating concession is temporary and strategic, whereas the operator is a permanent feature of correct assertion.
- D: Correct: the operator states the respect in which the predication holds, which is why it blocks absolutisation without weakening assertion.

Examiner trap: "The jar conditionally exists" is not a guess that the jar probably exists; treating syāt as a hedge converts a realist doctrine into scepticism.

MCQ 18. The fourth of the seven predications

In the sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī), the fourth member is

- A. syād asti ca nāsti ca, in some respect it is and it is not
- B. syān nāsti, in some respect it is not
- C. syād avaktavyam, in some respect it is inexpressible
- D. syād asti ca avaktavyam, in some respect it is and is inexpressible

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: the successive conjunction of affirmation and negation is the third member, not the fourth.
- B: Incorrect: simple negation is the second member and is one of the three primitives from which the rest are built.
- C: Correct: inexpressibility is the third primitive and stands as the fourth member, arising when affirmation and negation are demanded simultaneously and unqualifiedly.
- D: Incorrect: the combination of affirmation with inexpressibility is the fifth member, which presupposes the fourth already stated.

Examiner trap: Three primitives taken singly, in pairs and jointly give three plus three plus one; misplacing inexpressibility breaks the combinatorial derivation that explains why there are exactly seven.

MCQ 19. The meaning of inexpressibility

In the sevenfold predication, avaktavya chiefly signifies that

- A. the proposition takes a third truth-value lying between plain truth and plain falsity
- B. the object in question lies wholly beyond language and can be approached only in silence
- C. a single unqualified expression cannot convey affirmation and negation simultaneously
- D. the speaker suspends judgement because the available evidence is insufficient for assertion

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: a third truth-value would make the operator a semantic value rather than a standpoint index, which Jaina authors do not claim.
- B: Incorrect: mystical ineffability is not the Jaina claim, since the same object is expressible under each separate index.
- C: Correct: inexpressibility records a limit of simultaneous unqualified expression, not a limit of reality or of the speaker's evidence.
- D: Incorrect: suspension of judgement is scepticism, whereas each of the seven forms is an assertion under a stated condition.

Examiner trap: Inexpressibility is a fact about one utterance, not about the thing; the same jar is perfectly expressible once the respect is separated out.

MCQ 20. Why no contradiction arises

The Jaina claim that "in some respect the jar is and is not" escapes formal contradiction because

- A. the law of non-contradiction is denied outright, and Jaina logic replaces it with a rule of graded assertion
- B. one of the two predications is always merely conventional and is finally cancelled by the other
- C. affirmation is literal while negation is figurative, so the two predicates never occupy the same logical plane
- D. affirmation and negation are indexed to different substance, place, time or mode, so the respects differ

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: the doctrine preserves non-contradiction rather than abandoning it, which is precisely how it answers Śaṃkara.
- B: Incorrect: cancellation of one level by another is the Advaita structure of sublation, which Jaina aspect-realism does not employ.
- C: Incorrect: no Jaina text makes negation figurative; both predications are literal and both are true under their own index.
- D: Correct: contradiction requires the same respect, time and sense, and the four indices guarantee that this identity never obtains.

Examiner trap: Without naming substance, place, time and mode the reply to the contradiction charge is an assertion rather than an argument, and examiners mark exactly that difference.

MCQ 21. The self-refutation objection

The standard self-refutation objection against many-sidedness argues that

- A. the doctrine presupposes a creator who guarantees that the many aspects of a thing form a coherent whole
- B. if every assertion must be qualified then the doctrine itself must be qualified, and it then loses universal force
- C. the doctrine cannot explain how a single soul is reborn while remaining numerically the same individual
- D. the seven predications are too few, since the number of aspects in a real thing is admittedly innumerable

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: no critic derives a creator from many-sidedness, and Jainism denies a creator on independent grounds.
- B: Correct: the dilemma is that qualification appears to weaken the thesis while non-qualification appears to violate its own rule.
- C: Incorrect: personal identity across rebirth is answered by the enduring substance, and it is not what the self-refutation charge targets.
- D: Incorrect: the number seven is derived combinatorially from three primitives and does not claim to enumerate aspects.

Examiner trap: The Jaina reply accepts the first horn rather than escaping the dilemma: the thesis is itself asserted conditionally, and that obedience is offered as evidence of consistency.

MCQ 22. The 2022 absolutism charge

Which is the strongest Jaina reply to the claim that non-absolutism cannot be sustained without postulating absolutism?

- A. Non-absolutism is a purely practical maxim of debate and therefore makes no claim about reality that could be absolute
- B. Non-absolutism concerns only religious language, so the objection misapplies a logical test to a devotional context
- C. Non-absolutism denies one-sided exclusivism by finite knowers, while omniscience remains the internal case of complete knowledge
- D. Non-absolutism is asserted absolutely, and the resulting exception is accepted as the necessary cost of any general theory

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: reducing the doctrine to a debating maxim abandons its ontological content and concedes the triviality charge instead.
- B: Incorrect: many-sidedness is asserted of reality generally, so restricting it to religious language misdescribes the doctrine.
- C: Correct: the charge equivocates between denying exclusivism and denying comprehensiveness, and separating them dissolves the alleged contradiction.
- D: Incorrect: claiming an open exception is exactly what the objection alleges and would confirm rather than answer it.

Examiner trap: The reply does not eliminate the unconditioned; it relocates it to omniscience, and a critical answer should record that residue rather than declare a clean victory.

MCQ 23. What is distinctive about Jaina action-matter

Which statement best captures the Jaina conception of action and moral consequence (karma)?

- A. It is subtle matter that flows toward the soul and adheres to it, with passion determining the depth and duration of that adhesion
- B. It is a mental impression left by volition, so that continuity of character is secured without any enduring bearer
- C. It is an unseen quality residing in the self that produces its result at the appointed time without material mediation
- D. It is an unseen potency generated by ritual action alone, which links the act performed to the result eventually enjoyed

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- A: Correct: action-matter is a form of matter, and the pairing of activity with passion fixes what is bound and for how long.
- B: Incorrect: a mental impression without a bearer is the Buddhist *vāsanā*, which cannot supply Jaina material bondage.
- C: Incorrect: an unseen quality of the self is the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika *adr̥ṣṭa*, which Jainism replaces with genuinely material particles.
- D: Incorrect: a ritual potency is the Mīmāṃsā *apūrva*, and it is neither material nor tied to the passions in the Jaina manner.

Examiner trap: Writing "karma" without "material" loses the single thesis that makes the Jaina account distinctive among Indian theories of moral consequence.

MCQ 24. Two forms of bondage

Which pair correctly distinguishes the two forms of bondage recognised by the Jainas?

- A. Psychic bondage is the soul's own passionate modification, while material bondage is the actual adhesion of karmic particles
- B. Psychic bondage is the intention behind an act, while material bondage is the external act as observed by others
- C. Psychic bondage is bondage to mental objects, while material bondage is bondage to physical objects such as wealth and body
- D. Psychic bondage occurs in ascetics who retain subtle pride, while material bondage occurs only in householders

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- A: Correct: *bhāvabandha* is a modification of the soul and *dravyabandha* is the material adhesion it attracts, and the two are distinct yet interlinked.
- B: Incorrect: reducing the pair to intention and outward act loses the ontological claim that karmic matter really adheres.

- C: Incorrect: the distinction is not between kinds of object but between the soul's state and the matter that adheres to it.
- D: Incorrect: both forms operate for any bound soul; the ascetic-householder difference concerns the scope of vows, not the kinds of bondage.

Examiner trap: Collapsing the two forms costs either the moral psychology or the ontology; the 2024 paper asks for the distinction precisely because it carries both.

MCQ 25. The five causes of bondage

Which set correctly gives the five causes of bondage recognised in Jaina soteriology?

- A. Ignorance, craving, clinging, becoming and birth
- B. Anger, pride, deceit, greed and delusion
- C. Influx, bondage, stoppage, shedding and liberation
- D. Wrong vision, non-restraint, carelessness, passions and activity

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: this is a Buddhist chain of dependent origination and has no place in a Jaina list of causes of bondage.
- B: Incorrect: anger, pride, deceit and greed are the passions, so this option expands one cause into the whole list.
- C: Incorrect: these are stages of the soteriological sequence, four of which are remedies or outcomes rather than causes.
- D: Correct: wrong vision, non-restraint, carelessness, passion and activity are the standard five, with passion supplying adhesion and activity the channel.

Examiner trap: The passions are one member of the list, not the list itself; a script that gives four passions plus delusion has answered a different question.

MCQ 26. What determines what in bondage

Which pairing of a bondage parameter with its principal determinant is correct?

- A. Duration is determined by activity, while type is determined by passion
- B. Intensity is determined by activity, while quantity is determined by passion
- C. Type is determined by wrong vision, while duration is determined by carelessness
- D. Type and quantity are determined by activity, while duration and intensity are determined by passion

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: it reverses the division of labour, and duration is the parameter most clearly governed by the passions.
- B: Incorrect: it also reverses the pairing, since intensity of fruition tracks passion and quantity of matter tracks activity.
- C: Incorrect: wrong vision and carelessness are causes of bondage, not determinants of these four technical parameters.
- D: Correct: activity fixes which karma and how much, while passion fixes how long and how strongly, which is why passion-free activity binds only momentarily.

Examiner trap: This pairing is the technical basis of the contrast between momentary and durable bondage; reversing it silently destroys the Jaina ethics of intention.

MCQ 27. Destructive and non-destructive karmas

Which set contains only destructive (ghātiyā) karmas?

- A. Vedanīya, nāma, gotra and āyus
- B. Jñānāvaraṇīya, darśanāvaraṇīya, vedanīya and gotra
- C. Jñānāvaraṇīya, darśanāvaraṇīya, mohaniya and antarāya
- D. Mohaniya, antarāya, nāma and āyus

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: all four members are non-destructive, since they determine felt experience, body, status and lifespan without obscuring essential qualities.
- B: Incorrect: it mixes two knowledge- and perception-obscuring karmas with two that merely structure embodiment.
- C: Correct: these four obstruct knowledge, perception, right orientation and power, which is why their destruction yields omniscience at the thirteenth stage.
- D: Incorrect: it pairs two genuinely destructive karmas with two that determine body and lifespan.

Examiner trap: Deluding karma is the most dangerous of the destructive group because it corrupts both right vision and right conduct; omitting it from the destructive set is a substantive error.

MCQ 28. Seven principles and nine categories

The nine categories (padārtha) of Jaina exposition consist of

- A. the six substances together with influx, bondage and liberation, which complete the cosmology
- B. the seven principles together with substance and mode, which supply the ontological framework
- C. the seven principles together with merit and demerit, which make moral valence explicit
- D. the seven principles together with right knowledge and right conduct, which complete the path

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: the six substances are a different enumeration and are not combined with three members of the sevenfold list.
- B: Incorrect: substance and mode belong to the general theory of the real and are not added to the sevenfold list.
- C: Correct: merit and demerit are added to the seven principles, and they can also be subsumed under influx and bondage.
- D: Incorrect: right knowledge and right conduct belong to the three jewels and are not counted among the categories.

Examiner trap: Merit is still bondage; treating it as a stage on the way to liberation confuses a better rebirth with release from rebirth altogether.

MCQ 29. Stoppage and shedding

Which statement correctly distinguishes stoppage (saṃvara) and shedding (nirjarā)?

- A. Stoppage removes karma already bound, while shedding prevents new karma from being bound at all
- B. Stoppage blocks fresh influx of karmic matter, while shedding wears away karma already accumulated

- C. Stoppage belongs to householders and shedding to ascetics, the two being stages of a single vow
- D. Stoppage and shedding are alternative names for the same disciplinary process, differing only by tradition

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: it exactly reverses the two functions, which is the most frequent error in answers on the soteriological sequence.
- B: Correct: stoppage is preventive and shedding is eliminative, which is why vows and austerity are both required for liberation.
- C: Incorrect: both operate at every level of practice, and neither is restricted by monastic status.
- D: Incorrect: the sequence lists them as distinct stages precisely because bondage has two independent problems, arrival and accumulation.

Examiner trap: Austerity accelerates shedding but does not replace stoppage; sweeping a room whose door stands open is the image the tradition itself invites.

MCQ 30. The eleventh stage of spiritual development

With reference to the fourteen stages, which statement is correct?

- A. The eleventh stage only suppresses delusion, so a soul reaching it by that ladder necessarily falls back
- B. The eleventh stage is the momentary activity-free condition immediately preceding the perfected state
- C. The eleventh stage marks the attainment of right vision for the first time and is the decisive breakthrough
- D. The eleventh stage destroys delusion permanently and therefore leads directly to the twelfth and thirteenth stages

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- A: Correct: suppressed delusion is covered rather than destroyed, so the ladder of suppression cannot hold the eleventh stage.
- B: Incorrect: the momentary activity-free condition is the fourteenth stage, immediately before the perfected state.
- C: Incorrect: the first stable attainment of right vision is the fourth stage, which is the decisive breakthrough of the ascent.
- D: Incorrect: destruction of delusion is the twelfth stage, reached by the ladder of annihilation rather than by suppression.

Examiner trap: Suppression and destruction look identical from outside and have opposite futures; the two ladders exist to explain spiritual relapse without treating it as failure of insight.

MCQ 31. Omniscience while embodied

The condition described as sayoga-kevalī is best characterised as

- A. a soul that has suppressed all passions and awaits the fruition of its deluding karma before liberation
- B. an omniscient being still embodied and active, whose destructive karmas are destroyed while non-destructive karmas remain
- C. a perfected soul at the summit of the world, disembodied and free from every trace of karmic matter
- D. a householder who has taken the lesser vows and attained limited clairvoyant knowledge of material things

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: mere suppression belongs to the eleventh stage and is incompatible with the omniscience that defines this condition.
- B: Correct: destruction of the destructive karmas yields omniscience, while the remaining non-destructive karmas sustain embodiment and activity.
- C: Incorrect: the disembodied perfected soul is the siddha, which follows only after the fourteenth stage.
- D: Incorrect: lesser vows and clairvoyance belong far lower on the ladder and involve no destruction of the obscuring karmas.

Examiner trap: This is the Jaina form of liberation-in-life; denying that omniscience can coexist with embodiment misreads the destructive and non-destructive division of karmas.

MCQ 32. Voluntary passionless death

Which statement about sallekhanā is doctrinally the safest to write in an examination?

- A. It is a meritorious act of self-destruction that may be undertaken by any practitioner who wishes to shorten a difficult life
- B. It is identical with suicide in every philosophically relevant respect, differing only in the vocabulary used to describe it
- C. It has been conclusively settled in Indian law as a protected religious practice, so its legal status raises no further question
- D. It is a gradual, supervised and passion-free relinquishment of food undertaken when death is already unavoidable or decline incurable

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- A: Incorrect: a wish to shorten life is itself a passion and converts the observance into a transgression of the vow's own discipline.
- B: Incorrect: suicide is sudden, passion-driven and often concealed, whereas the vow is gradual, passionless, non-violent and public.
- C: Incorrect: legal holdings must not be asserted without verification, and an examination answer should report the controversy rather than settle it.
- D: Correct: the vow requires equanimity, supervision, gradualness and the absence of any desire for death or for continued life.

Examiner trap: The doctrinal test is the inner state, not the outward abstention; if desire for death, attachment or hope of reward enters, the act becomes a transgression rather than a fulfilment of the vow.